Township of NIPISSING
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REPORT TO COUNCIL

Date: July 14, 2026

From: Kris Croskery-Hodgins, Municipal Administrator-Clerk-Treasurer
Kim Turnbull, Deputy Treasurer-Office Assistant

Re: Asset Management Annual Review for Council

Background:

An Annual Review of progress in Asset Management (AM) provides a line of sight for Council into the Township's major capital assets including Roads, Bridges & Culverts, Facilities & Land Improvements, and Fleet & Equipment. This report tracks changes to assets and the services they provide since the Township's Asset Management Plan (AMP) was adopted, addressing Capital Delivery, Levels of Service (LOS), and AM Approaches, including barriers and steps ahead. This report, prepared in accordance with *Ontario Regulation 588/17: Asset Management Planning for Municipal Infrastructure.*

Summary:

- Capital delivery in 2025-2026 was generally aligned with the AMP. The Alsace Road surface treatment project was reduced due to cost, but remaining sections are expected to be treated in 2027. Bridges and Culverts continue to be an area of focus for rehabilitation in the coming years.
- Levels of Service targets were generally met, except for Bridges and Culverts, as described below.
- The Township will continue to collaborate with neighbouring municipalities on shared projects, seek funding from programs such as NORDS, and remain focused on efficient and effective capital project implementation to achieve the service objectives defined in the AMP.

Capital Delivery:

Capital delivery in 2025-2026 was generally aligned with the AMP, which outlines the types of projects to complete and approximate timing at a high level. Project scope, timing, and costs are determined through Township Council approvals and budget processes, as well as during tendering and project implementation. This summary of capital delivery identifies changes to assets that impact on asset condition, capacity, or service levels over the past year, relative to the AMP:

Roads Capital Projects

- One road project planned for 2026, surface treatment on Alsace Road, has been scaled back due to available funding and higher-than-anticipated costs. Preparation work is in progress, and the municipality may be able to complete approximately 3 km next year, depending on final costs.
- Capital priorities have shifted toward bridges and culverts due to recent structure-related issues and sources of funding. Staff are working to align roadwork with bridge and culvert rehabilitation needs.
- Regular scheduled work continued on surface treated roads in the north end of the municipality.

Bridges and Culverts

- Hummel Bridge: The municipality is applying for funding for Hummel Bridge. The project may proceed as early as 2027, subject to funding and approvals.

- Bear Creek Culvert: Work is in progress for 2026, converting the culvert to a bridge. Approximately $1 million in funding has been identified. Tendering is on schedule.
- Hart Culvert: Shared with Callander, major rehabilitation is expected to proceed in 2027. The culvert requires immediate attention. Two steel plates have been purchased to support a temporary repair and maintain access until replacement. The steel plates may also be available for use on future projects. NORDS funding may support the project between the two municipalities.

Facilities and Land Improvements

- Outdoor Rink: Replaced outdoor rink boards and lighting.
- Playground: Installed new wood chips at the playground; surfacing is up to date.
- Museum Building: Completed foundation repairs at the Museum Building. The work was completed at a lower cost than anticipated, at approximately $20,000.
- Public Works Garage: Roof repairs were completed. The work had been identified for 2026.
- Chapman's Landing Dock: Budget has been identified for dock work at Chapman's Landing. Timing is expected to be either by the end of 2026 or in 2027.
- Community Centre: Fitness Centre equipment was purchased for the Community Centre, including a treadmill, bike, and universal weight machine. The municipality continues to contribute approximately $10,000 annually to reserve for fitness centre equipment renewal.

Fleet and Equipment

- Half-Ton Truck: The oldest half-ton truck is being disposed of; a replacement vehicle has been ordered.
- Grader: The municipality is currently using a loaner grader. Replacement was required following equipment breakdown. A new grader is expected to arrive shortly, within 2026.
- Backhoe: A new backhoe was acquired in 2025.
- Ford Escape: Replacement of the Ford Escape has been deferred to 2027.
- Fire Truck: 2011 Pumper Tanker - replacement of pump #2 on the 2011 pumper tanker is now expected to move to 2027. Estimated cost is approximately $500,000.

Levels of Service:

Overall, the Township generally met its proposed levels of service in 2025-2026. The review of current performance against the AMP considers whether service levels are improving, stable, or declining, and highlights factors or risks that may affect future service delivery:

Roads: Target Met

- There was one unplanned road closure in 2025, on Rye Road. Maintenance and culvert repairs have been completed to reduce this risk. The target is fewer than two unplanned closures per year.
- The Township received two written complaints related to winter maintenance on Alsace Road in 2025. These concerns were addressed with the complainants. The target is no more than 10 formal complaints per year.
- There were no road closures of hills due to significant weather events this year.
- Maintenance activities were completed within applicable Minimum Maintenance Standards.
- Based on 2025 results, no adjustment to the current roads service level is required.

Bridges and Culverts: In Progress / Working Toward Target

- Regular OSIM bridge and culvert inspections are due in 2026 and should provide BCI ratings.
- The Hummel Bridge remains closed to traffic, and 4 structures have loading restrictions.
- Identified funding needs for bridges and culverts in 2026 have been met, including Bear Creek.
- Continued attention to bridges and culverts remains important given the scale of upcoming work and the need to coordinate structure renewal with road capital planning.

Facilities: Target Met

- There were no unplanned incidents requiring a facility closure in 2025. The target is one or fewer unplanned facility closures per year.
- Facility-related priorities have been added to the Township's 10-year capital forecast for 2026–2036.
- Based on 2025 results, the Township achieved its facilities service level target.

Fleet and Equipment: Target Met

- Two vehicles are currently beyond their expected useful life, unchanged since 2025. One vehicle is currently planned for retirement, and the other will be replaced in 2027.

Asset Management System, Barriers, and Next Steps:

The Township made progress in asset management by completing its Asset Management Plan in 2025, including updates to asset data and an evaluation of lifecycle needs. The AMP identifies renewal priorities, future investment requirements, and supports capital planning with detailed asset information. The Township's Asset Management Policy was last updated in 2023 and remains in place for governance and decision-making.

Barriers to Implementation

The Township is required to identify barriers to the successful implementation of the AMP. Challenges include maintaining current asset data, refining risk and priority assessments, and further integrating AMP findings into budgeting, reserves, and long-term financial planning. Specific barriers identified in 2025-2026 include:

- *Capital funding constraints:* Bridge and culvert works are putting pressure on the Township's capital funding, requiring external funding or shared municipal contributions. Also, higher-than-anticipated project costs have already resulted in some road work being scaled back or deferred.
- *Emergency and unplanned infrastructure needs:* Flooding and unexpected culvert failures required emergency response and funding adjustments. These can redirect resources from planned renewal work and affect the timing and outcomes of implementing the AMP.
- *Coordination with neighbouring municipalities:* Shared assets, such as boundary road structures and culverts, require continued coordination on timing, funding, design, and delivery. Collaboration is necessary but adds complexity to capital planning and implementation.
- *Climate and weather-related impacts:* Heavy rainfall, flooding, and changing weather patterns have increased pressure on roads, culverts, drainage assets, and operations budgets. Continued monitoring and integration of climate risks into future AMP updates will help set asset priorities in this context.
- *Asset data and information systems:* The Township has improved its asset data through the AMP update, but ongoing data management remains an important task. Consistent data structure, condition updates, lifecycle tracking, and project records are important to maintain future data integrity.

Improvements for 2026-2027

The Township will continue to address its asset requirements according to the AMP, capital forecasts, and relevant studies, including the Roads Needs Study. Key improvements for 2026-2027 include:

- Roads projects had to scale back because of funding, but the Township will aim to implement what was scaled back next year and catch up in the following years until Alsace Rd. is fully resurfaced.
- Township will focus on preventive maintenance, to not always have to do full rehabilitations on roads.
- 2027 is a gravel run year, reserves are ready to re-gravel set portions of gravel roads.
- Township is actively pursuing sources of funding for Hummel Bridge, NORDS funding for the Hart Rd. Culvert, and other projects. Grant funding is critical to implementing major capital works.
- Fire Fleet: Moving Pump 2 from 2028 to 2027 for major maintenance, to get it in the queue as suppliers take a long time to fulfill this type of order and costs have risen significantly.
- Assessing replacement of the Admin/Building vehicle (Ford Escape) with a vehicle suitable to share with the Fire department when required.
- Continuing to implement initiatives as planned and completing works on schedule in 2026.

Recommendation:

That this 2025-2026 Annual Review of Progress in Asset Management be received by Council, as an update related to the 2025 AMP. The review helps Council to monitor how the Township is managing capital assets and following long-term financial plans for sustainable delivery of services to the community.

Respectfully,

Kris Croskery-Hodgins
Municipal Administrator-Clerk-Treasurer

Kim Turnbull
Deputy Treasurer-Office Assistant